First time opening SpaceKeeper

macOS checks apps from the internet the first time you open them. SpaceKeeper isn't sold through Apple, so you need to tell your Mac once that it's OK. This takes about a minute and you only do it once.

1 Copy SpaceKeeper into Applications

In the SpaceKeeper window, drag the **SpaceKeeper** icon onto the **Applications** folder. (Skip this if you've already done it.)

2 Try to open it

Open **Finder**, click **Applications** in the sidebar, then double-click **SpaceKeeper**. Your Mac shows a message like this:

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

“SpaceKeeper” Not Opened

Apple could not verify “SpaceKeeper” is free of malware that may harm your Mac or compromise your privacy.

Move to Bin | Done

Click **Done**. Don't click **Move to Bin** (it may say **Move to Trash**).

3 Open Privacy & Security

Click the **Apple menu** (the apple logo) in the top-left corner of the screen, choose **System Settings**, then click **Privacy & Security** in the sidebar.

4 Click “Open Anyway”

Scroll down to the **Security** section. You'll see this:

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

“SpaceKeeper” was blocked to protect your Mac. Open Anyway

Click **Open Anyway**, then type your Mac password (or use Touch ID). If your Mac asks once more, click **Open Anyway** again.

> **Can't see Open Anyway?** It only shows for about an hour after step 2. Double-click SpaceKeeper in Applications again, click **Done**, and look again.

5 SpaceKeeper is open

SpaceKeeper has no window of its own. It lives in the **menu bar** at the top-right of your screen as a small icon of stacked squares. Click it to open the panel. From now on it opens normally, like any other app.

Can't see the icon? Open **System Settings › Menu Bar** and make sure SpaceKeeper is switched on.

Getting started

1 Keep your desktops in order

In the SpaceKeeper panel, turn on **Keep Spaces in a fixed order**. The Dock restarts once; that's normal.

2 Allow switching

Click **Enable Switching…**. In **Privacy & Security › Accessibility**, switch **SpaceKeeper** on. This lets SpaceKeeper move you between desktops. If the panel shows **Turn On Shortcuts**, click it too.

3 Name, colour and pin

Double-click a desktop to give it a name. Right-click it to choose a colour or pin it in place. Click a desktop to go to it.

4 Open SpaceKeeper quickly

Press the control key twice quickly, or click the menu bar icon.

Is this safe?

The warning appears because SpaceKeeper isn't registered with Apple's paid developer programme. It doesn't mean anything is wrong with it. SpaceKeeper is free and open source: anyone can read its code on GitHub. It doesn't collect or send any of your information.

Only download SpaceKeeper from its official GitHub page. If you got it from somewhere else, delete it.

Removing SpaceKeeper

Open the SpaceKeeper panel and choose **Quit**. Then drag **SpaceKeeper** from **Applications** to the **Bin**.

When you've finished installing

You can close the SpaceKeeper install window and eject the **SpaceKeeper** disk in Finder's sidebar (click ⏏ next to it). You can delete the downloaded **.dmg** file too.